

July

15

1890

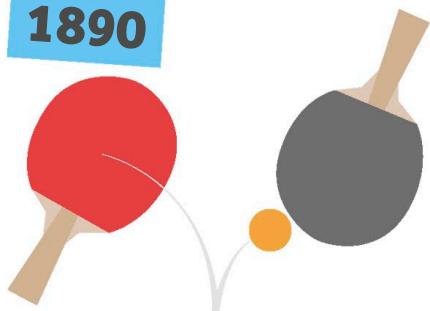


Table tennis

David Foster, a British inventor, filed a patent for the game of table tennis. His version featured a rubber ball, rackets with strings, and a small wooden perimeter fence.

Also on this day

1099/1244 Christian forces captured the city of Jerusalem in the Holy Land in 1099, bringing the First Crusade to an end. Exactly 145 years later to the day, the Crusaders lost Jerusalem to a Muslim army in 1244.

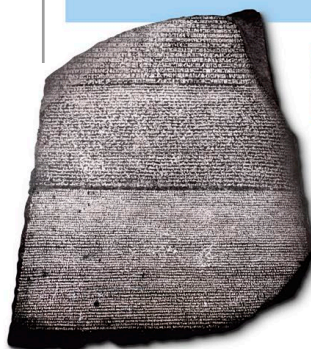
1965 The *Mariner 4* spacecraft flew as close as 9,846 km (6,118 miles) to Mars. Its photos of the Red Planet were the first taken from space of a planet other than Earth.

2010 Argentina became the first South American country to legalize same-sex marriages.

1799

Code breaker

The Rosetta Stone, a rock carved with the same inscription in three different ancient languages, was discovered near Rashid, Egypt. It helped scholars decipher the hieroglyphic writing used in ancient Egypt.



Born this day

1606 Rembrandt, Dutch painter. He was a master of different styles and subjects, such as portraits (including his own) and landscapes.

1914 Prince Birabongse Bhanudej, Thai prince, sailor, pilot, and racing driver. He was the first Southeast Asian driver to compete in Formula 1 racing.

The Great Stink

A bill was passed to clean out the waste dumped in the River Thames in London, UK, to rid the city of the "Great Stink" it caused. This led to an improved sewer system.

1858

